IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE [TBD]

The Board of Education of the San Carlos School District (District) proposes to replace the District's existing special parcel tax with a new special parcel tax to support various educational purposes, as outlined below. The District's existing parcel tax (Measure N) will cease to be collected as of July 1, 2027. This Measure, if approved by voters, would authorize a new parcel tax in the amount of $489 per parcel per year, for a period of up to eight years, commencing July 1, 2027. The amount of the tax is subject to annual adjustment based on the Bay Area Consumer Price Index, and is estimated to raise approximately $4,400,000 annually. [97]

The proposed parcel tax applies to any unit of real property in the District that receives a separate tax bill for ad valorem property taxes from the San Mateo County tax collection officials. Any person who is 65 years of age or older as of July 1 of the tax year, and who owns and occupies a parcel within the District, may apply for an exemption from the tax. An exemption is also available to any person who receives Supplemental Security Income for a disability, regardless of age, and to any person who receives Social Security Disability Insurance benefits, regardless of age, whose annual income does not exceed 250 percent of the 2012 federal poverty guidelines. Property owners who are currently exempt from the District's existing parcel tax (Measure N) under a comparable owner-occupied, single-family residence exemption will be automatically exempted from this Measure without filing a new application. [142]

The stated purposes of the proposed parcel tax are to: [10]

- Attract and retain qualified and experienced teachers;
- Maintain small class sizes;
- Maintain quality science, technology, math, reading, and writing instruction;
- Maintain hands-on science, math, and technology programs;
- Maintain school libraries; and
- Provide art, music, and other well-rounded educational programs. [39]

The Measure does not authorize use of tax proceeds for administrators' salaries or pensions. [14]

The proceeds of the parcel tax will be placed in a special account. A report accounting for the amount collected and expended, and the status of any projects or programs funded by the tax, will be filed with the Board of Education at least once a year. The Board of Education will establish an independent citizens' oversight committee to review the expenditures of the tax and ensure the proceeds are applied only to the purposes authorized. [72]

The District's appropriations limit shall be increased in each year the parcel tax is levied, in the amount of the funds raised by the tax in that year. [28]

A "yes" vote on this Measure would impose on property within the District an annual parcel tax of $489, subject to annual adjustment based on the Bay Area Consumer Price Index, for up to eight years beginning July 1, 2027, for the purposes listed above. [39]

A "no" vote on this Measure would not allow the parcel tax to be levied. [15]

This Measure passes if at least two-thirds of those voting on the Measure vote "yes". [15]

---------- End of Analysis ----------

(500 word limit. 471 words)